

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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I am writing to apply for the Criminal Paralegal role at Reed, supporting your client's criminal defence and regulatory practice in Reading.

My background sits squarely in the areas this firm is known for. At BCLP, I spent six months in International Arbitration and six months in Real Estate Disputes, drafting procedural documents, preparing hearing bundles, reviewing evidence for submissions, and coordinating documents under deadline pressure — including a period where I was the only junior supporting the arbitration team before a significant filing. I also supported skeleton arguments and court materials in the disputes team, which gave me direct exposure to litigation preparation at a level a partner described as comparable to a newly qualified solicitor.

On the regulatory and investigative side, I have a sustained interest in how regulatory frameworks interact with individual rights — reflected in my LLM dissertation on GDPR development across jurisdictions (Distinction, 75%) and my practical experience at Q-Legal advising a start-up on UK GDPR compliance risks. At Citizens Advice, I now manage matters from instruction to submission: taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps, translating complex procedural rules into clear practical guidance for vulnerable clients, and drafting correspondence and document schedules to deadline. That combination of client-facing judgement and case management discipline maps directly onto what serious crime and regulatory defence work demands.

I am drawn to this firm's reputation for serious crime, fraud, and regulatory investigations specifically — these are areas where rigorous evidence handling, procedural precision, and clear communication with clients under pressure genuinely matter, and where I believe my experience is most relevant.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the role further and am available at your convenience.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Fernanda Silva